

Old Garden roses

This category is so large that it is divided into two groups. Roses in Group A are mostly of European origin, while those in Group B are hybrids between Oriental and European roses.

Group A

Alba—large, freely branching shrubs with only a few prickles on the stems. They bear clusters of 5–7 semi- to fully double, scented flowers in midsummer, on shoots from second-year wood. Have abundant, grayish-green leaves. Are very hardy. Most are good for borders and as hedges or as specimen plants.

Centifolia (or **Provence**)—lax, thorny shrubs that produce often scented, double to fully double flowers, borne singly or in 3s, in summer, on shoots from second-year wood. Leaves are matte, dark green. Are suitable for borders.

Damask—open shrubs with prickly stems and downy leaves. They produce often very fragrant, semi- to fully double flowers, borne singly or in loose clusters of 5–7 mainly in summer, on shoots from second-year wood; a few also flower on new wood in fall. Are suitable for borders or training against a support.

Gallica—shrubs of fairly dense, free-branching habit, with usually thorny stems, and mostly dull, dark green leaves. Produce mostly scented, single to fully double, richly colored flowers, often in clusters of 3, in summer on shoots from second-year wood. Are suitable for borders and as hedging.

Moss—often lax shrubs with a furry, mosslike growth on stems and calyces. Leaves are usually dark green. Usually fragrant, semi- to fully double flowers, often in clusters of 3 or more, are borne on very thorny shoots from second-year wood in summer. Are suitable for beds and borders.

Scots (or **Scotch**)—Suckering shrubs, selections or hybrids of *R. spinosissima*, of low, spreading, rarely upright habit, with prickly stems and dark green leaves. Occasionally scented, single to double flowers are solitary or borne in clusters of 3 or more, on short stems from second-year wood, usually in early summer. Are suitable for beds and borders.

Sweet Briar—Vigorous, free-branching shrubs with usually thorny stems and sweetly scented, dark green leaves. In summer, they bear usually scented, single to double flowers, singly or in clusters of up to 7, on short shoots from second-year wood. Use as hedges, as specimen plants, and in large borders.

Group B

Bourbon—large, open, repeat-flowering shrubs and climbing roses, often with long, smooth or prickly stems, which may be trained to climb. They have often glossy leaves and numerous scented, double or fully double flowers, borne commonly in 3s, in flushes in summer and usually fall. Flowers are borne on short shoots from second-year wood and on new wood. Are suitable for borders and for training over fences, walls and pillars.

Boursault—climbing roses with long, arching, usually smooth stems and dark green leaves. They bear slightly scented,

semidouble or double flowers, singly or in clusters of 3, in early summer, on short shoots from second-year wood. Grow against a sheltered wall or fence.

China—spindly, repeat-flowering shrubs with mostly smooth stems, bearing only a few reddish-brown prickles, and glossy leaves. They produce sometimes scented, single to fully double flowers, singly or in clusters of 3–13, in flushes in summer–fall. Flowers are produced on short shoots from second-year wood and on new wood. Need a sheltered site. Are suitable for borders and walls.

Hybrid Musk—Vigorous, repeat-flowering shrubs with prickly stems and abundant foliage. They produce mainly double blooms, often very fragrant, either singly or in clusters of 2–7 or more, in flushes from midsummer to fall. Are good for shrub borders, and can be trained on walls.

Hybrid Perpetual—free-branching, repeat-flowering shrubs with upright, prickly growth and dark green leaves. They bear often scented, fully double flowers, held singly or in 3s, in flushes in summer–fall on shoots from second-year wood and on new wood. Are suitable for beds and borders.

Noisette—repeat-flowering climbing roses that bear clusters of 3–15 usually double to fully double flowers, with a slight spicy fragrance, in flushes in summer–fall. Flowers are borne on shoots from second-year wood, occasionally on new wood. Have generally smooth stems and glossy leaves. Are suitable for sheltered, south- or west-facing walls.

Portland (or **Damask Portland**)—upright, compact, repeat-flowering shrubs with thorny stems and usually dark green leaves. They produce usually scented, semi- to fully double flowers, held singly or in 3s, in flushes in summer–fall, mainly on shoots from second-year wood. Are suitable for beds and borders.

Sempervirens—vigorous, semievergreen climbing or rambler roses with shiny, light green leaves. Arching, thorny stems bear clusters of 3–15 unscented, semi- to fully double flowers in summer, on short stems from second-year wood. Are ideal for naturalizing or for growing on fences and pergolas.

Tea—repeat-flowering shrubs and climbing roses with smooth to thorny stems, sometimes bearing a few large, red prickles, and glossy, light or sometimes dark green leaves. They produce spicy-scented, slender-stemmed, semi- to fully double flowers, borne singly or in 3s, in flushes in summer–fall, on shoots from second-year wood and on new wood. Need a sheltered site. Are suitable for beds and borders and trained against walls.

Modern roses

Climber—often vigorous climbing roses with thorny, arching, stiff stems and usually dense, glossy, mid- to dark green foliage. They bear generally scented flowers in a variety of forms, singly or in clusters of 3–7 or more. Some bloom in summer only, on short shoots from second-year wood; many are repeat-flowering and also flower on new wood.

Train against walls, fences or use to cover garden structures.

Climbing Miniature—Repeat-flowering, climbing roses with restrained, sparsely thorny growth. Clusters of 3–9 tiny, rarely scented, single to fully double flowers are borne in flushes in summer–fall, on shoots from second-year wood and on new wood. Grow against low walls, fences and pillars.

Floribunda (or **Cluster-flowered bush**)—repeat-flowering, free-branching shrubs of upright or bushy habit, usually with prickly stems and glossy, dark green leaves. Sometimes scented, single to double flowers are usually in clusters of 3–25, rarely solitary, and are produced continuously in summer–fall on shoots from second-year wood and on new wood. Are excellent for borders and as hedges.

Groundcover—trailing and spreading roses, mostly with prickly stems, producing often glossy leaves. They bear clusters of numerous, sometimes scented, single to fully double flowers; some flower in summer only, on short shoots from second-year wood; others are repeat-flowering, and also flower on new wood. Many bear flowers all along the stems. Are ideal for beds, banks, and containers, and for trailing over walls.

Hybrid Tea (or **Large-flowered bush**)—repeat-flowering, free-branching shrubs of upright or bushy habit, with usually prickly stems and glossy or matte, mid- to dark green leaves. Large, often scented, usually double flowers are borne singly or in 3s in flushes in summer–fall on shoots from second-year wood and on new wood. Use in formal borders, as hedges and for cut flowers.

Miniature—repeat-flowering shrubs with very compact, rarely spreading, sparsely prickly, short growth. Sprays of 3–11 tiny, rarely scented, single to fully double flowers are borne in flushes in summer–fall on very short shoots from second-year wood and on new wood. Have tiny leaves. Are suitable for edging paths and driveways, and for rock gardens, raised beds, and container growing.

Patio (or **Dwarf cluster-flowered bush**)—repeat-flowering shrubs with compact growth, sometimes prickly stems, and usually glossy leaves. They bear clusters of 3–11 usually unscented, single to double flowers in flushes in summer–fall, on shoots from second-year wood and on new wood. Are ideal for beds, borders, and as hedges and for growing in containers.

Polyantha—compact, repeat-flowering shrubs with sparsely prickly stems and glossy leaves. Sprays of many small, rarely scented, single to double flowers are borne in summer–fall on shoots from second-year wood and on new wood. Are suitable for beds and borders, as hedges, and for containers.

Rambler—a diverse group of vigorous roses with long, arching, prickly stems and dense, usually glossy foliage. They have clusters of 3–21 sometimes scented, single to fully double flowers, mainly in summer, on short shoots from second-year wood and on new wood. Train over walls, fences, pergolas, and into trees.

Rugosa—Hardy shrubs with tough, wrinkled, usually bright green leaves and prickly stems. Most bear scented, single, or semidouble flowers, in clusters of 3–11, in summer–fall, on short shoots from second-year wood. They are often followed by tomatolike, usually red hips. Use as hedges, for beds, and borders and as specimen plants.

Shrub—Roses in this diverse group are usually larger than bush roses (a general term used to describe Floribundas, Hybrid Teas, Miniatures, Patio roses, and occasionally Groundcover roses). They often have prickly stems and bear usually scented, semidouble to double flowers in few- to many-flowered clusters, sometimes singly, in summer–fall. Some bloom in summer only from second-year wood; most are repeat-flowerers and also flower on new wood. Use as hedges, in beds and borders, and as specimen plants.

R. ABRAHAM DARBY ('Auscot') illus. p.183.

R. ABSOLUTELY FABULOUS. See *R. JULIA CHILD* ('Wekvossutono').

R. 'Agnes'. Bushy Rugosa rose with upright stems. H 6ft (2m), S 4ft (1.2m). Cupped, double, scented, light yellow flowers, 3in (8cm) across, are borne in early summer (a few later). Leaves are rough, ribbed, and clear green. Z3–9

R. 'Aimée Vibert'. Noisette rose with smooth stems and glossy, dark green leaves. H 10–15ft (3–5m), S 10ft (3m). Bears fully double, scented white flowers, 2½in (6cm) across, from summer–fall. May be grown as a shrub. Z5–9

R. 'Alba Semiplena', syn. *R. × alba* 'Semiplena'. Vigorous, bushy Alba rose. H 7ft (2.2m), S 5ft (1.5m). Bears sweetly scented, flat, semidouble, white flowers, 3in (7cm) across, in midsummer. Leaves are grayish-green. Z6–9

R. 'Albéric Barbier' illus. p.184.

R. 'Albertine' illus. p.185.

R. ALEC'S RED ('Cored') illus. p.181.

R. ALEXANDER ('Harlex') illus. p.180.

R. 'Alfred de Dalmas' of gardens. See *R. 'Mousseline'*.

R. 'Alister Stella Gray'. Noisette climbing rose with long, vigorous, arching stems and neat, mid-green leaves. H 15ft (5m), S 10ft (3m). Quartered-rosette, fully double, musk-scented, yolk-yellow flowers, fading to white, 2½in (6cm) across, are borne freely from summer–fall. Z5–9

R. 'Aloha' illus. p.185.

R. AMBER QUEEN ('Harroony').

Spreading, Floribunda bush rose with abundant, reddish foliage. H 20in (50cm), S 2ft (60cm). Amber flowers, 3in (8cm) across, are fragrant, rounded, and fully double; repeat-flowering from summer–fall. Z6–9

R. 'American Pillar'. Vigorous Rambler of lax growth, with leathery, glossy, mid-green foliage. H to 15ft (5m), S 12ft (4m). Large clusters of cupped, single, carmine-red flowers, 2in (5cm) across, with white eyes, are borne freely in midsummer, and followed by scarlet hips. Z6–9

R. 'Angel Face'. Slow-growing Floribunda (prune only lightly) with dark green foliage. H 32in (80cm), S 28in (70cm). Bears clusters of double, very strongly scented, lilac flowers with ruffled petals, 4in (10cm) across, almost continuously. Z5–9